

Running CIS Compliance Assessments

Learn how to configure and run automated CIS Benchmark assessments for Microsoft 365, view results, and understand compliance findings.

Overview

The Assessment feature allows you to run **ad-hoc (manual)** CIS compliance scans on your Microsoft 365 environment. You can select specific benchmarks, rule sets, or run comprehensive assessments covering all CIS controls.

 **Note:** This page is for running **ad-hoc/manual assessments** on-demand. To set up **automated scheduled assessments**, see the [Scheduled Scans](#) documentation.

For more information, visit configcobra.com.

How to Run an Ad-Hoc Assessment

This section explains how to run **manual (ad-hoc) assessments** on-demand. For automated scheduled assessments, see [Scheduled Scans](#).

Step 1:  Log in to ConfigCobra

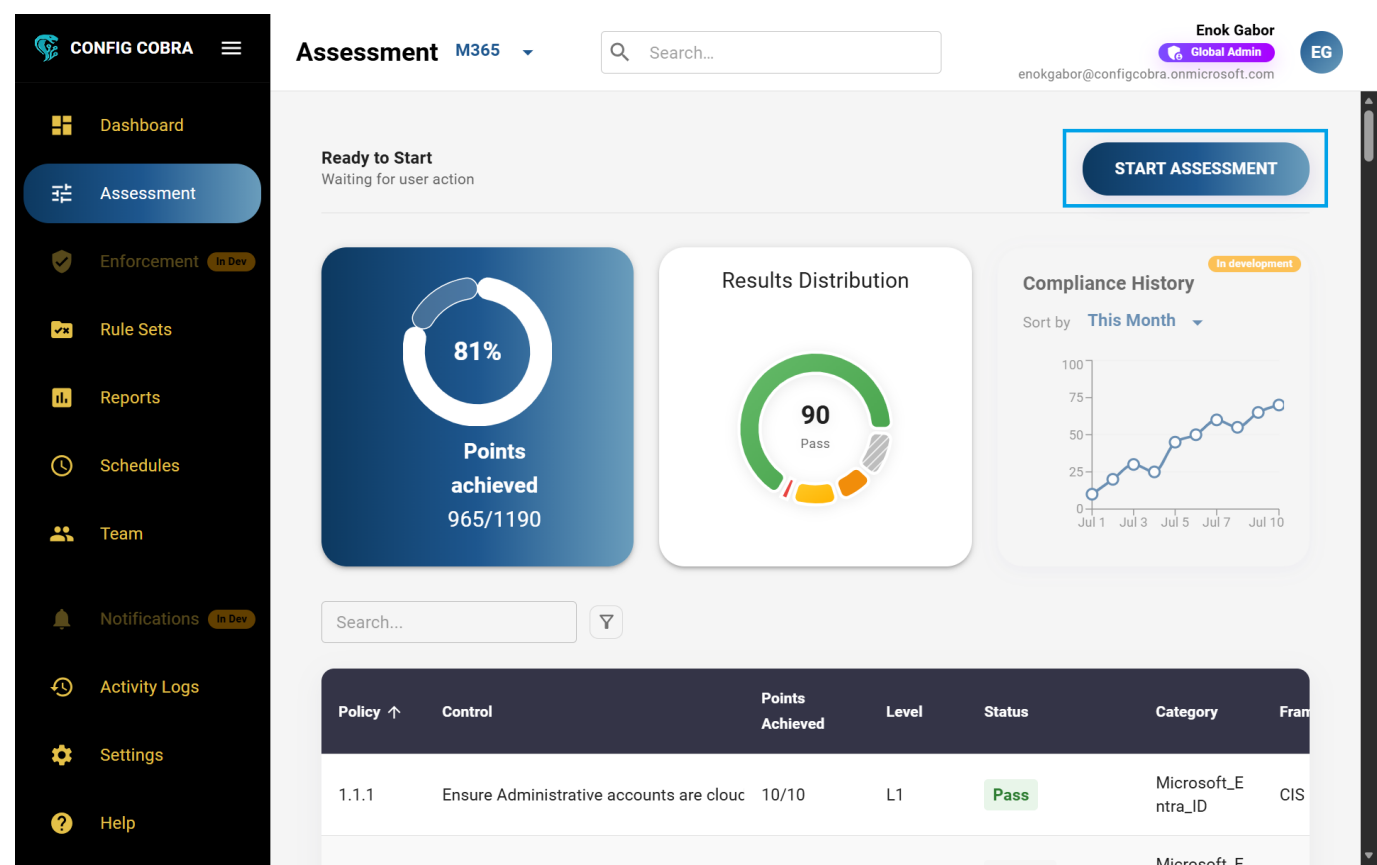
Log in at app.configcobra.com using your credentials.

Step 2:  Navigate to Assessment tab

Go to the **Assessment** tab in the main navigation menu.

Step 3:  Start a new assessment

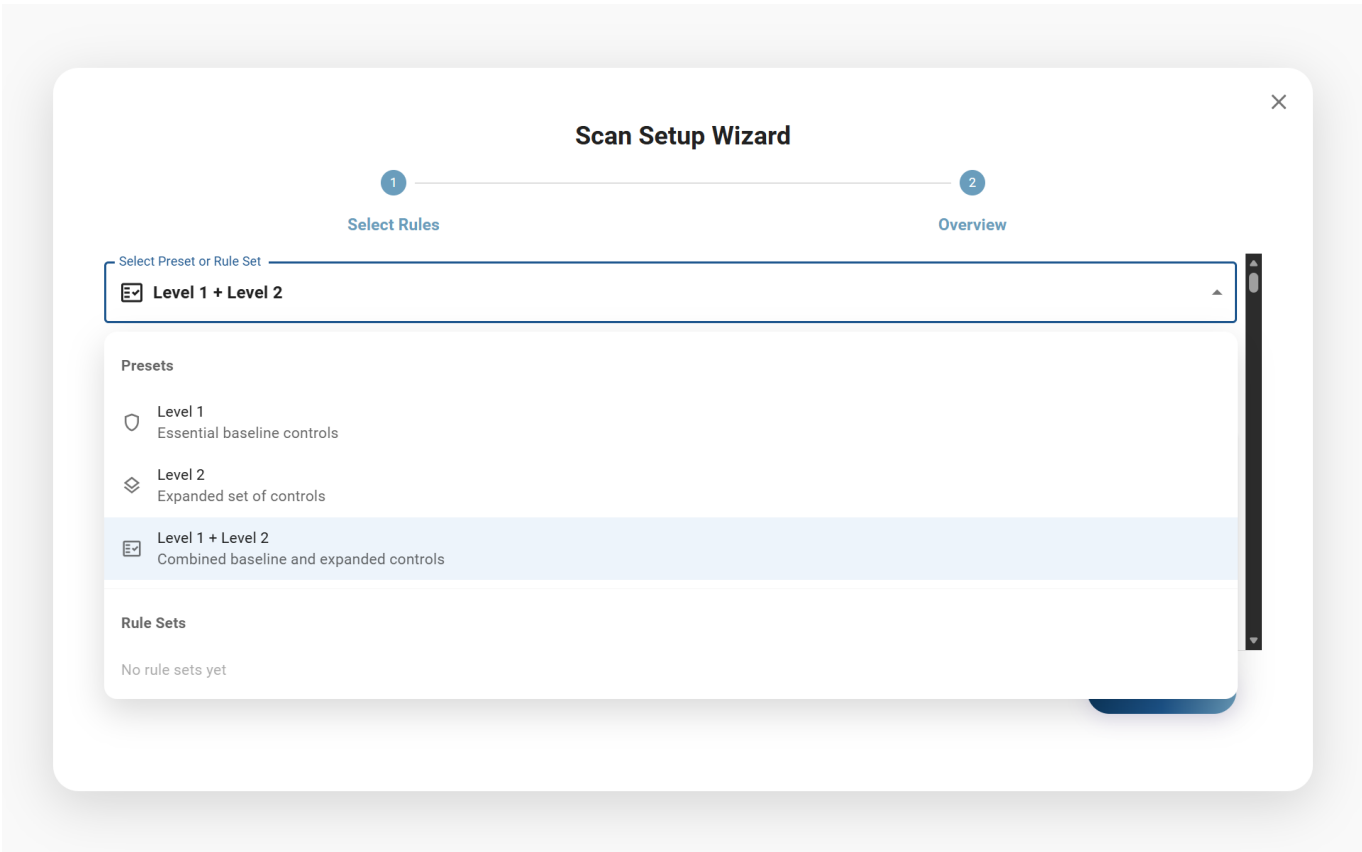
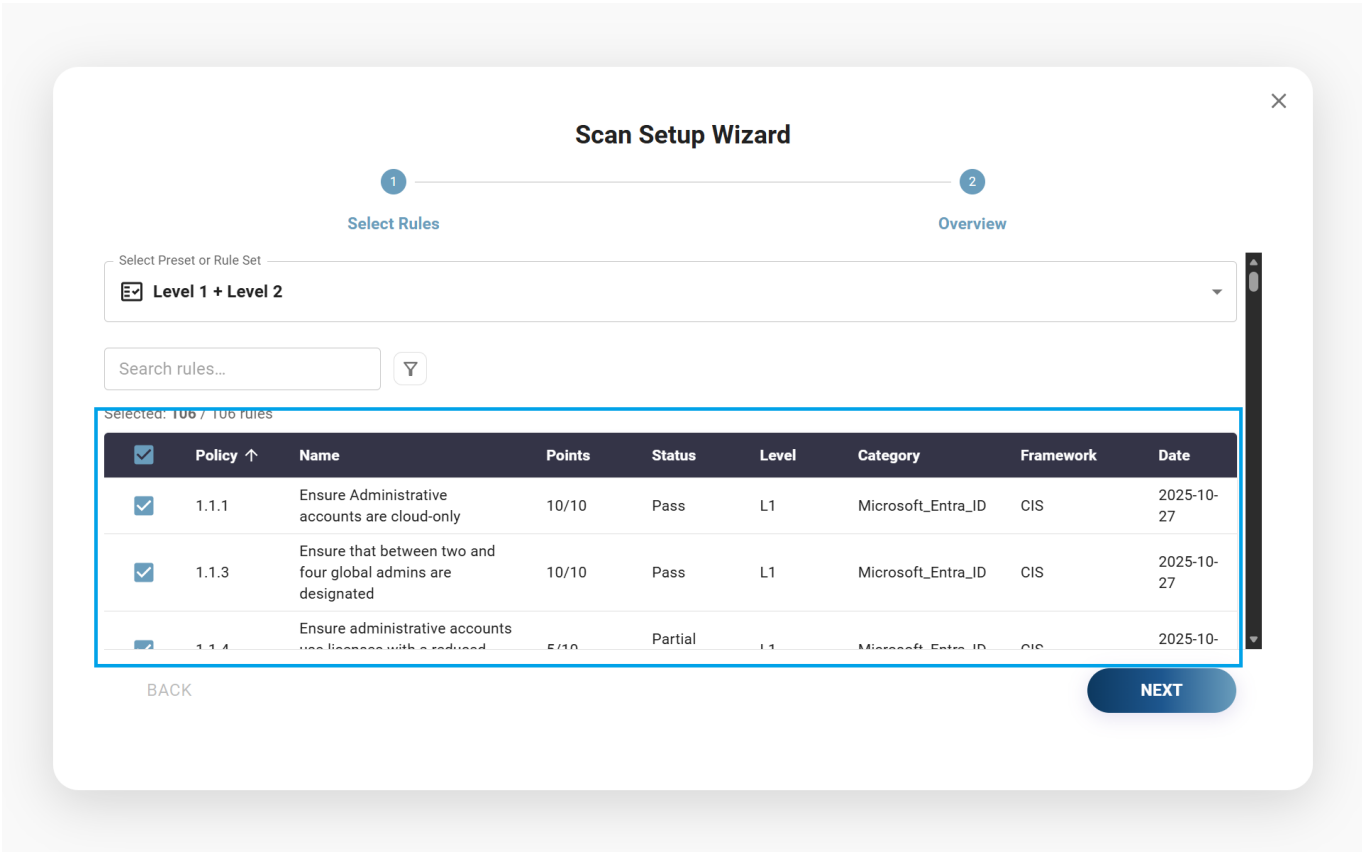
Press "**Start Assessment**" in the right corner of the Assessment page.



Step 4: Select your benchmarks

Select the desired benchmarks you want to assess. You can choose from:

- **Level 1**  – Essential security controls recommended for all systems
- **Level 2**  – Enhanced security controls for sensitive environments
- **Both Level 1 and Level 2** benchmarks
- **Predefined rule sets**  – Learn more about [rule sets](#)
- **Custom selection by benchmark** 

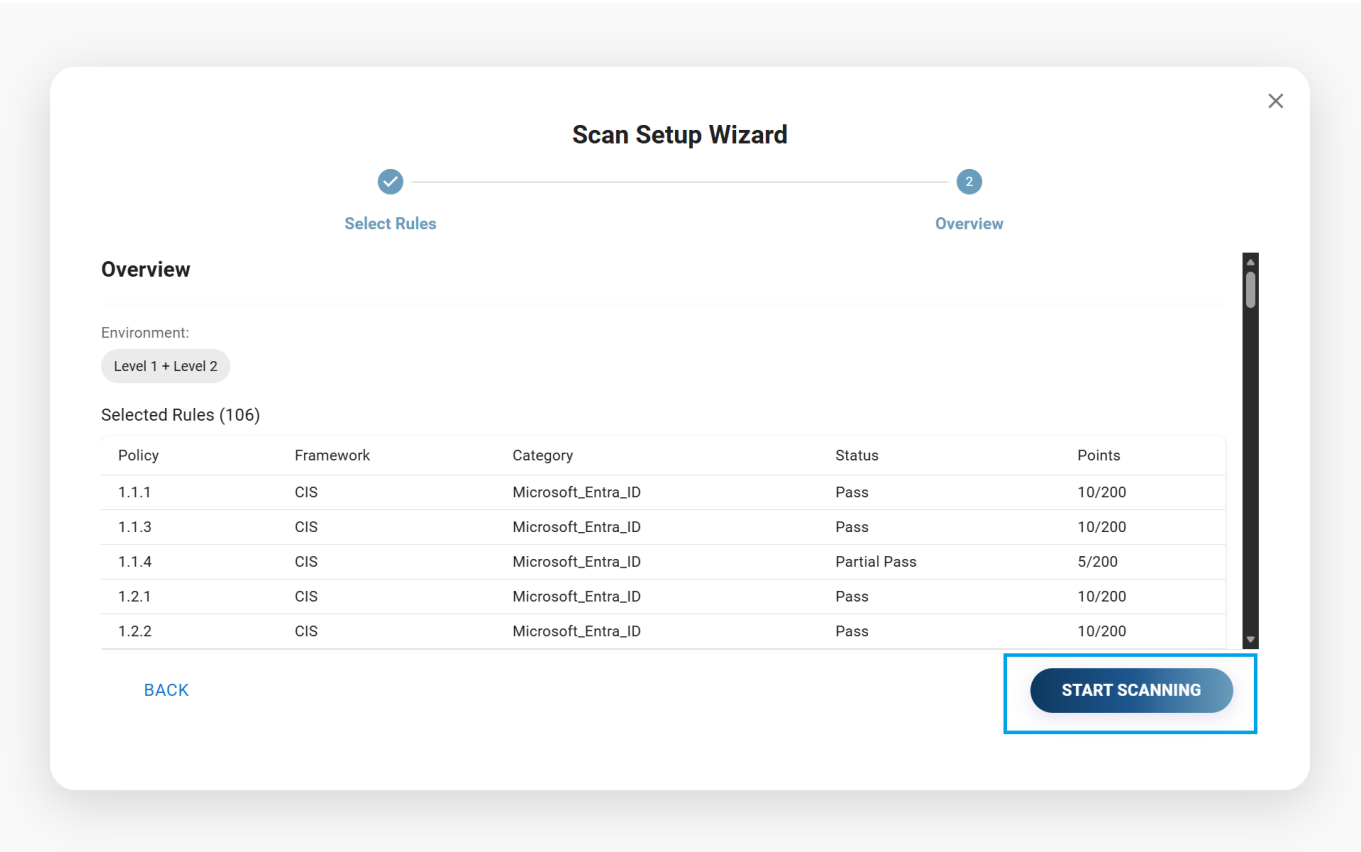


Step 5: Review and start scanning

You will see an **Overview** page of your scan configuration, showing:

- ☒ Selected benchmarks and rule sets
- Controls that will be assessed

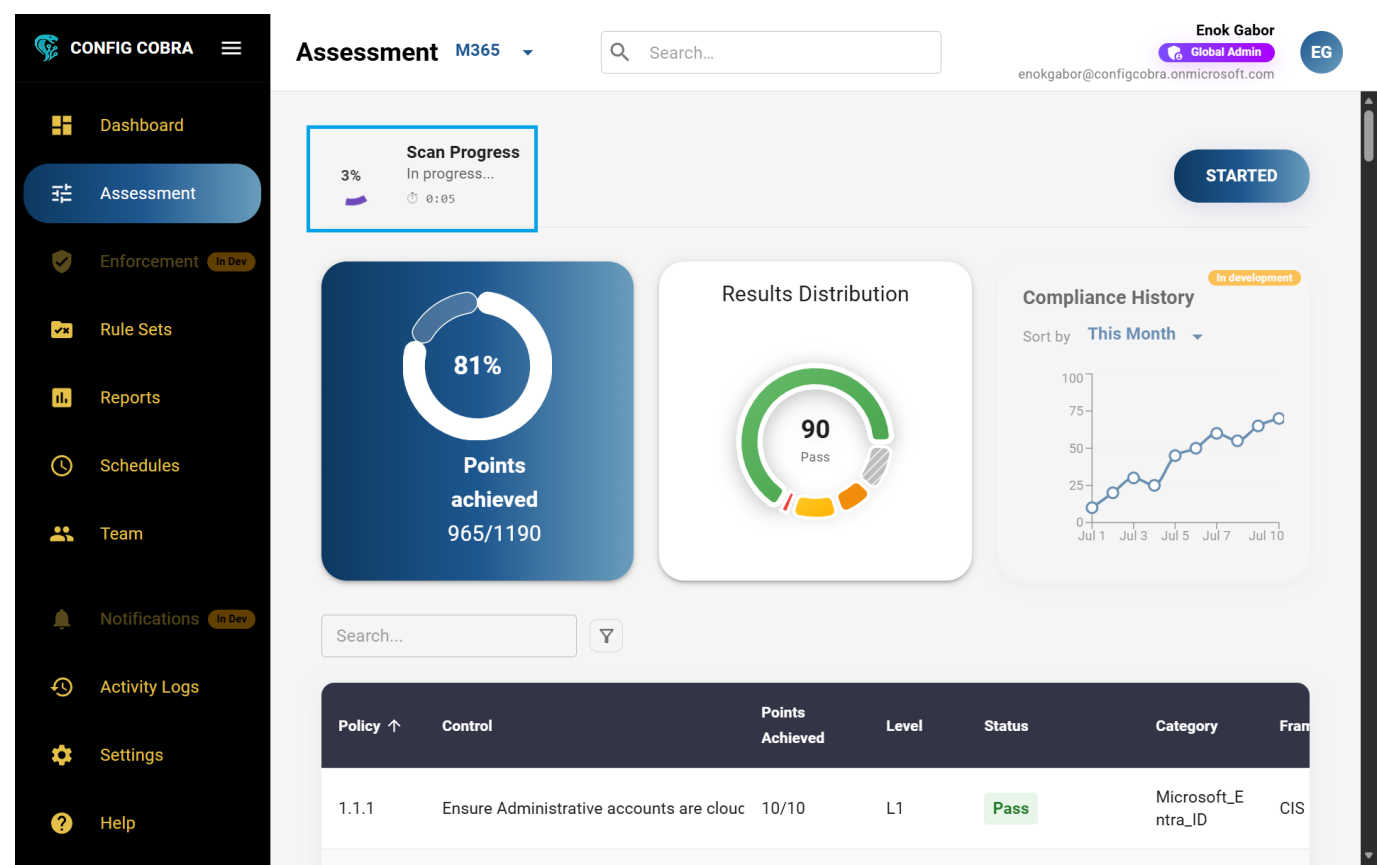
If you are happy with the configuration, press **START SCANNING** to begin the assessment.



Step 6: ⌚ Wait for results

After starting the scan, ConfigCobra will automatically assess your Microsoft 365 configurations. The process typically takes:

🕒 **20-25 minutes** depending on your user count. Larger organizations may experience longer scan times.



Once complete, you will be able to see the results on the **Assessment page** as well as on the [Reports page](#).

Understanding Assessment Results

After an assessment is complete, by clicking on each benchmark you can see detailed information including:

Outcome

Pass, Fail, or Warning status

Description

Detailed explanation of the control

Impact

Security and compliance implications

Audit

Evidence and audit trail information

Remediation

Step-by-step instructions to fix issues

Configuration

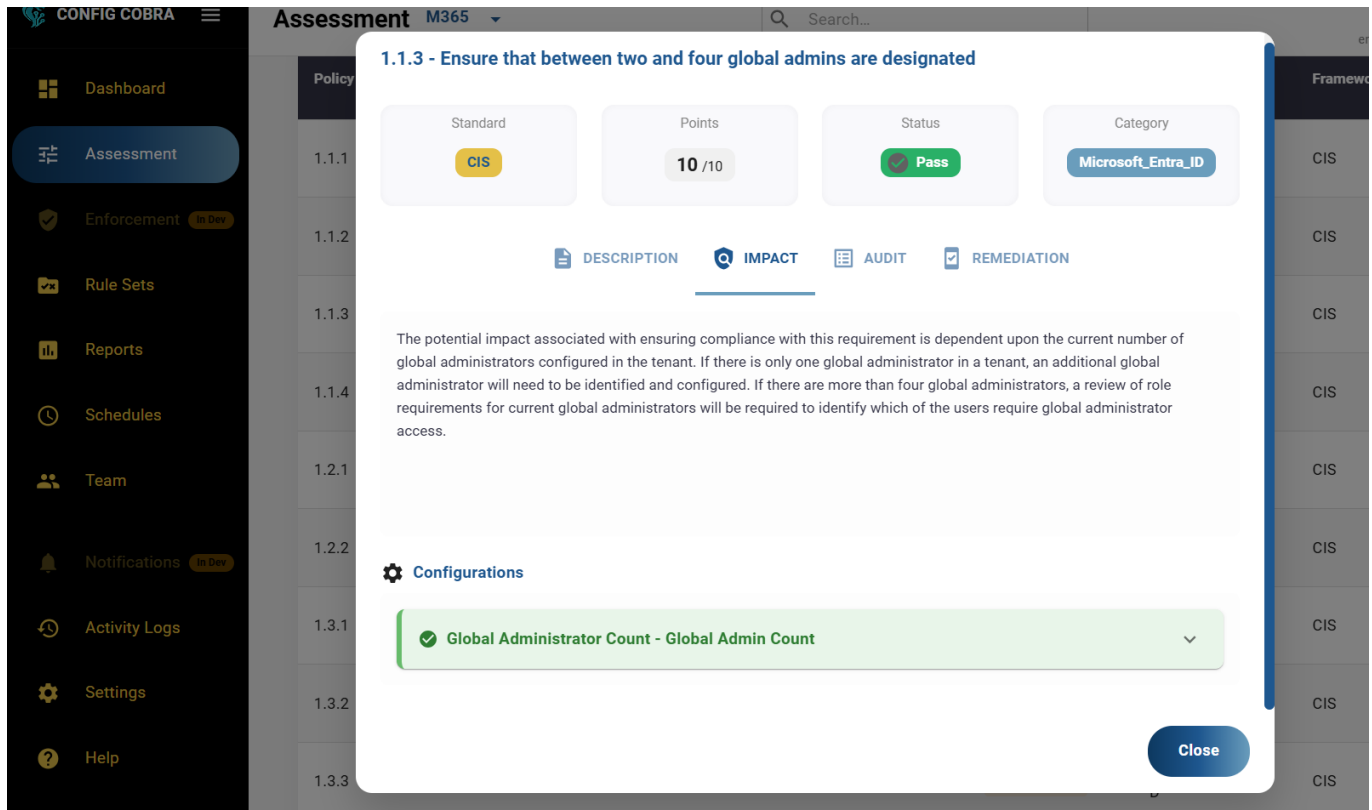
Current settings in your tenant

Assessment History

 **Important:** On the Assessment page, you can only see your **last assessment** at any given time. To view historical assessments and compare results over time, visit the [Reports page](#).

Assessment Outcomes

Reports display three different types of outcomes for each control assessment:



The screenshot shows the CONFIG COBRA Assessment page for M365. A modal window displays details for control 1.1.3: "Ensure that between two and four global admins are designated". The modal includes a summary section with four cards: Standard (CIS), Points (10/10), Status (Pass), and Category (Microsoft Entra ID). Below this is a tabbed interface with four tabs: DESCRIPTION, IMPACT, AUDIT, and REMEDIATION. The IMPACT tab is selected, showing a detailed description of the control's potential impact. At the bottom, there is a "Configurations" section with a green bar indicating "Global Administrator Count - Global Admin Count" is compliant. A "Close" button is located at the bottom right of the modal.

Pass

The control is fully compliant with the CIS Benchmark requirement. All configuration settings meet the specified criteria.

Fail

The control does not meet the CIS Benchmark requirement. One or more configuration settings are not compliant and require remediation.

Partial Pass

The control partially meets the CIS Benchmark requirement. Some configuration settings are compliant, but others need attention.

Best Practices

-  Run assessments regularly to track compliance over time
-  Start with Level 1 benchmarks for initial assessments
-  Use rule sets to focus on critical controls
-  Review remediation guidance for failed controls

-  Schedule automated assessments for continuous monitoring
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